Sam McAulay

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SUMMARY

I am a motivated, technically skilled final-year software development student. Recognised on the Dean's Honours List for academic excellence. Developer of an award-winning video game showcased at the 2025 Games Fleadh. I bring a strong blend of technical skills, sales and customer satisfaction knowledge, and collaborative experience.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Developer
Jan 2026 – May 2026

Khora, Athlone (remote)

- Successfully led and completed a full-stack project as a solo developer, meeting tight deadlines and client expectations.
- Designed and implemented scalable system architectures from scratch, enhancing application performance and reliability.
- Conducted effective customer meetings to gather requirements and provide technical insights.
- Deployed the application to production via Git Actions CI/CD, ensuring seamless integration and operation.
- Delivered engaging live demos, improving client satisfaction and trust.
- Exceeded customer expectations through methodical planning and over-delivering.

Crew Member
Apr 2025 – Aug 2025

McDonald's, Athlone

- Greeted and served a high volume of customers efficiently, in a fast and friendly manner, maintaining high customer satisfaction.
- Accurately processed customer orders, managing cash transactions and maintaining a balanced cash drawer.
- Prepared a wide range of drinks and desserts, receiving positive feedback from customers.
- Maintained KPIs by ensuring efficient service and teamwork.
- Monitored stock levels, efficiently communicating needs to the management team.
- Received recognition for outstanding customer service and teamwork from management.

Volunteer, Special Needs Childcare
Jan 2023 – Present

Birr, Co. Offaly

- Worked with children with many developmental and learning disabilities.
- Developed personalised communication strategies for problem solving and task facilitation.
- Leveraged specialised knowledge of neurodiversity to build strong relationships, maintain a positive environment, and prevent overstimulation.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Software Design with Virtual Reality and Gaming — Sep 2023 – Present

Technological University of the Shannon, Midlands, Athlone

- On course for a 1:1 final grade.
- Presented several works at campus open days.
- Recognised on the Dean's Honours List.
- Student council participation.

SKILLS

Programming: C#, C, C++, Python, SQL, Java, web services, Bash and Fish scripting

Game engines: Unity, Unreal, Godot, GameMaker

Hardware: computer repairs, construction and configuration

Certified: Microsoft Office, GMetrix, 2024

Professional: time management, leadership and collaboration, interpersonal communication

ACHIEVEMENTS

Lead Game Developer, Moonhaul. Award-winning physics-based video game, recognised for Best Gameplay, Best Use of a Physics Engine and Best Soundtrack.

Tall Columns Art Exhibition, Birr, 2022

Rookie Lifeguard Certification, Birr Leisure Centre, 2019

INTERESTS

Fragrance and luxury perfumery. I have created several prototype perfumes to date.

Physical music. I have a broad collection of CDs and vinyl records; I believe it is important to preserve this media in its intended form.

Computer hardware. I have built several machines and server rigs for friends and family, saving them time and money.

Jewellery and high fashion. Assisted with creating a web landing page for new luxury watch launches and information.

REFERENCES

Available on request.